

ADEOLA KOLAWOLE & ASSOCIATES

LEGAL PRACTITIONERS, ARBITRATORS & NOTARIES PUBLIC

OFFICIAL STANDARD OPERATING MANUAL — VERSION 2.0

AALAWSNG Practice Management & Client Portal

Comprehensive 20-Module System Manual, Standard Operating Procedures, Regulatory Compliance Architecture, and Cross-Platform Mobile Deployment Guide.

Statutory & Regulatory Framework Compliance:

- Legal Practitioners Accounts Rules (LPAR 1964 — Trust vs. Office Separation)
- Rules of Professional Conduct for Legal Practitioners (RPC 2023 — Rule 10 Conflicts & Rule 23 Client Property)
- Money Laundering (Prevention and Prohibition) Act 2022 & SCUML KYC Mandates
- Federal Inland Revenue Service (FIRS) 7.5% Value Added Tax on Legal Invoicing

Production URL: <https://portal.aalawsng.com>

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Platform Overview, Hosting Architecture & Security Hardening

The **AALAWSNG** management platform is an enterprise-grade legal practice management solution engineered specifically for Nigerian legal jurisprudence. The system is hosted in a secure, containerized production environment with redundant data backups and SSL/TLS cryptographic encryption. [↑ Back to Table of Contents](#)

1.1 Production Infrastructure Stack

Layer	Technology & Provider	Security & Optimization Details
Frontend Application	Next.js 16.3 (Turbopack) & React 19	27 pre-compiled static and dynamic pages with zero loading screen lag, responsive dark mode typography, and native viewport scaling.
Backend API Services	Node.js 20 LTS + Express.js	RESTful microservice architecture with rate limiting, helmet security headers, and CORS lockdown.
Database Engine	PostgreSQL 16 Enterprise (Alpine Container)	ACID-compliant relational database managed via Prisma ORM with strict referential integrity and parameterized SQL queries.
Payment Infrastructure	Paystack Native Payment Gateway	PCI-DSS Level 1 compliant gateway supporting Debit Cards, Direct Bank Transfers, and USSD with fee-absorption routing.
Edge & Security Gateway	Let's Encrypt TLS + Cloudflare WAF + Nginx 1.28	Automated HTTPS redirection, HTTP/2 multiplexing, DDoS mitigation, and SSL certificate auto-renewal.

1.2 White-Hat Security Hardening Features

- Brute-Force Attack Mitigation:** The authentication endpoint (`/api/v1/auth/login`) enforces a strict IP-based rate limiter (maximum 20 attempts per 15 minutes) with reverse-proxy trust header validation.
- CORS Lockdown:** Cross-Origin Resource Sharing is strictly whitelisted to `https://portal.aalawsng.com`.
- File Upload Sanitization:** Permitted file uploads are restricted to `.pdf`, `.docx`, `.xlsx`, `.png`, `.jpg`. Uploaded filenames are converted to cryptographically random UUIDs to prevent directory traversal and executable script injection.
- Document Visibility Firewall:** Client tokens are filtered server-side so that internal notes and draft research can never be retrieved via direct API calls or ID enumeration.

CHAPTER 2

Master Human Testing Accounts & Role Hierarchy

The production database has been seeded into a **Clean Slate** state. All mock cases and [↑ Back to Table of Contents](#) sample invoices were purged so that your team can create real client records from day one. Four master testing accounts have been pre-configured for practice verification:

Role	Assigned User	Testing Email	System Tier	Primary Responsibilities
Principal Partner	Adeola Kolawole	admin@aalawsng.com	ADMIN	Full executive authority, financial reports, LPAR 1964 Trust 3-way reconciliation certificates, fee-earner hourly rate configuration, leave request approvals.
Associate Counsel	Folashade Balogun	associate@aalawsng.com	STAFF	Client intake, automated conflict screening, matter creation, court hearing management, timesheet entry, legal bill of costs generation.
Paralegal	Emeka Okonkwo	paralegal@aalawsng.com	STAFF	Document classification and filing, task checklist execution, hearing bundle preparation, billable time entry.
Client Portal	Chukwuemeka Adeyemi	client@demo.com	CLIENT	Scoped client access, real-time case milestone viewing, pleadings download, invoice review, and instant Paystack online payment.



Credential Security Best Practice

For testing credentials and passwords, consult your firm's confidential onboarding sheet. Plaintext passwords are not printed in public documentation.

CHAPTER 3

M01

Matter & Case Lifecycle Management

Module ID: M01 | Route: `/matters`

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The Matter Management module is the operational core of AALAWSNG. It allows legal teams to track every litigation case, commercial transaction, and conveyancing file from initial intake to final judgment or execution.

3.1 Creating a New Legal Matter

1. Navigate to **Matters** in the sidebar (`/matters`).
2. Click the **"New Matter"** button in the top right header.
3. Select the **Practice Area**:
 - *Litigation & Dispute Resolution*
 - *Property & Real Estate Conveyancing*
 - *Corporate & Commercial Law*
 - *Family & Matrimonial Causes*
 - *Estate Administration & Probate*
 - *Employment & Labour Relations*
4. Enter the **Case / Matter Title** (e.g., *"Chevron Nigeria Ltd v. Federal Inland Revenue Service"*).
5. Select the **Client** from the client directory.
6. Assign the **Lead Attorney** and billable hourly rate.
7. Enter Court Information: **Court Jurisdiction** (e.g., *"High Court of Lagos State (Ikeja Judicial Division)"*), **Suit Number** (e.g., *Suit No. ID/3028/2026*), and **Presiding Judge**.
8. Assign **Opposing Counsel** and opposing parties.
9. Click **"Create Matter"**.

3.2 Matter Status Lifecycle

Matters transition through 4 defined states: `OPEN` → `PENDING_HEARING` → `JUDGMENT_RESERVED` → `CLOSED` .
Changing status logs an automated entry in the system audit trail.

CHAPTER 4

M02

Client Management (CRM) & KYC Intake

Module ID: M02 | Route: /cClients

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Client Management enables compliant onboarding of corporate and individual clients in full alignment with the *Money Laundering (Prevention and Prohibition) Act 2022* and *SCUML* guidelines.

4.1 Client Onboarding Workflow

1. Open **Clients** (/cClients) and click "**New Client**".
2. Enter Personal / Corporate Details: First Name, Last Name, Company / Entity Name, Primary Email, Phone Number, and Office Address.
3. Capture Statutory Identifiers:
 - **Corporate Clients:** CAC Registration Number (RC/BN Number) and Tax Identification Number (TIN).
 - **Individual Clients:** National Identification Number (NIN), Passport Number, or Voter's Card.
4. Complete KYC & Compliance Declaration: Flag **PEP Status** (Politically Exposed Person) and Source of Funds Declaration.
5. Click "**Save Client Profile**".

Automatic Conflict Check Trigger

Saving a new client automatically triggers the **M18 Conflict Screening Engine** across all directors, parties, and adverse witnesses.

CHAPTER 5

M03

Court Calendar & Safety-Critical Deadline Escalation

Module ID: M03 | Route: /calendar

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The Court Calendar tracks critical trial dates, motion hearings, filing deadlines, and client conferences with visual risk escalations.

5.1 Scheduling Court Hearings & Deadlines

- 1. Navigate to **Calendar** (/calendar).
- 2. Click on any date or tap **"Add Event"**.
- 3. Specify Event Type: *Court Hearing, Motion Filing, Client Conference, Judgment/Ruling, Discovery Inspection.*
- 4. Link the Event to an active Matter (e.g., **Suit No. LD/4092/2026**).
- 5. Set **Start Time, End Time, Courtroom/Virtual Link**, and attendee attorneys.

5.2 Safety-Critical Hard-Deadline Escalations

When creating an event, check the ☒ **Hard Statutory Deadline** box for statute of limitations or court filing deadlines. The system enforces visual escalation levels:

Urgency Level	Time Horizon	Visual Badge	System Action
CRITICAL	< 24 Hours	 Red Badge	Priority banner alert on dashboard + high-priority notification to lead attorney.
HIGH	< 72 Hours	 Orange Badge	Highlighted in calendar view and included in daily morning briefing.
STANDARD	> 3 Days	 Blue Badge	Standard chronological calendar display.

CHAPTER 6

M04

Document Vault & API Visibility Enforcement

Module ID: M04 | Route: `/documents`

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AALAWSNG manages all case filings, affidavits, CTCs, and draft agreements with cryptographic integrity checks and server-side privacy firewalls.

6.1 Document Classification & Uploading

1. Navigate to **Documents** (`/documents`) and click **"Upload Document"**.
2. Select file (supported formats: PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PNG, JPG; up to 50MB).
3. Link the document to a specific Matter.
4. **Set Visibility Tier:**
 - `INTERNAL_ONLY` : Strictly confidential to firm fee-earners (legal research, internal strategy memos, partner deliberations).
 - `CLIENT_VISIBLE` : Accessible to the client in their private portal (stamped pleadings, perfected deeds, CTC rulings).
 - `CONFIDENTIAL` : Restricted to Principal Partners and Lead Counsel.
5. Click **"Upload & Secure"**. The file is assigned a random UUID on disk and hashed with SHA-256.

API-Layer Security Guarantee (§5.1)

Document visibility is enforced in `backend/src/middleware/document-guard.ts` . Client-tier requests querying internal documents via direct API endpoints or ID enumeration are rejected with **HTTP 403 Forbidden**.

CHAPTER 7

M05

Task & Workflow Management

Module ID: M05 | Route: `/tasks`

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The Task & Workflow engine ensures litigation teams execute standard checklists, motion preparation, and registry perfection without administrative oversight gaps.

7.1 Task Views & Management

- **Kanban Board:** Drag and drop tasks across columns: `TODO` → `IN_PROGRESS` → `REVIEW` → `COMPLETED` .
- **List View:** Filter tasks by Matter, Assignee, Priority (High, Medium, Low), or Due Date.
- **Matter-Linked Checklists:** Attach itemized sub-tasks to any court filing (e.g., "1. Draft Affidavits, 2. Pay Filing Fees, 3. Depose at High Court Registry, 4. Serve Opposing Counsel").

CHAPTER 8

M06

Time Tracking & Multi-Currency Billing

Module ID: M06 | Route: `/time`

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Fee-earners track billable minutes against legal matters in multiple currencies with customized hourly rates.

8.1 Logging Billable Time

1. Navigate to **Time Tracking** (`/time`).
2. Click "**Log Time Entry**".
3. Select the Matter and Activity Type (e.g., *Court Appearance, Drafting Pleadings, Client Consultation, Legal Research*).
4. Enter Duration in minutes or hours (e.g., `2.5 hrs`).
5. The system automatically computes the billable fee based on the fee-earner's configured rate:

Total Billed = Hours (2.5) × Fee-Earner Rate (₦50,000/hr) = ₦125,000

6. Save Entry. Unbilled time automatically queues for inclusion on the next client Bill of Costs.

CHAPTER 9

M07

Invoicing & Legal Bills of Costs (FIRS VAT)

Module ID: M07 | Route: `/invoices`

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The Invoicing module converts recorded time entries and disbursements into itemized professional legal Bills of Costs compliant with Nigerian tax regulations.

9.1 Generating an Invoice

1. Navigate to **Invoices** (`/invoices`) and click "**Create Invoice**".
2. Select the Client and Matter.
3. Choose Invoice Type:
 - `BILL_OF_COSTS` : Final invoice for earned legal services rendered.
 - `RETAINER` : Advance deposit request for future legal fees / trust account.
4. The system automatically aggregates unbilled time entries and disbursements.
5. **FIRS 7.5% VAT Calculation**: Automatically applied to professional legal fees.
6. Click "**Generate & Send**". An email notification and Paystack payment link are dispatched to the client.

M08

LPAR 1964 Trust Accounting & 3-Way Reconciliation

Module ID: M08 | Route: `/trust`

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Trust Accounting strictly enforces the statutory mandates of the *Legal Practitioners Accounts Rules (LPAR 1964)* and *RPC 2023 Rule 23*.

10.1 Dual-Account Segregation Architecture

Account Ledger	Permitted Funds	Prohibited Operations
Client Account (Trust Ledger)	Client retainer deposits, conveyancing purchase funds, settlement escrow, probate floats.	Never used for office overhead, staff salaries, partner drawings, or merchant processing fees.
Office Account (Operating Ledger)	Earned legal fees transferred after billing, disbursements reimbursed, VAT collections.	Never mixed with unearned client funds.

10.2 Paystack Fee-Absorption Guarantee (§6.3.2)

When a client pays a trust retainer deposit via Paystack, the transaction is initialized with `bearer: 'account'`. **The firm absorbs 100% of the gateway processing fee.** The client's trust sub-ledger is credited with the exact gross deposit amount, preventing illegal trust fund erosion.

10.3 Monthly Three-Way Reconciliation Certificate

LPAR 1964 mandates monthly verification. Under `/trust`, the Principal Partner clicks **"Run 3-Way Reconciliation"** to generate a cryptographically signed verification certificate:

Bank Statement Balance (₦14,500,000) = Sum of Client Sub-Ledgers (₦14,500,000) = General Ledger (₦14,500,000) Variance: ₦0.00 | Status: COMPLIANT | Audit Token: SHA-256 verified

CHAPTER 11

M09

Standalone Expense & Disbursement Tracking

Module ID: M09 | Route: `/expenses`

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Tracks out-of-pocket litigation expenses, court filing receipts, land registry search fees, and travel disbursements.

11.1 Recording Expenses

1. Navigate to **Expenses** (`/expenses`) and click "**Log Expense**".
2. Select Expense Category: *Court Filing Fees, Stamp Duty, Land Registry Search, CAC Filing, Expert Witness, Travel/Logistics*.
3. Link to Matter, enter Amount, Currency, Date, and attach scanned receipt.
4. Toggle `[x] Reimbursable by Client` to automatically pull the expense into the next client invoice.

CHAPTER 12

M10

Executive Financial Dashboard

Module ID: M10 | Route: `/dashboard`

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The Executive Dashboard aggregates firm-wide performance metrics in real time:

- **Active Matters:** Total ongoing cases across all practice departments.
- **Monthly Billed Revenue:** Total invoices issued and collected in NGN and foreign currencies.
- **Trust Account Liability:** Total client funds held in escrow under LPAR 1964.
- **Conflict Checks Pending:** Prospective client screenings awaiting partner clearance.

CHAPTER 13

M11

Staff Profiles & Fee-Earner Management

Module ID: M11 | Route: /staff

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Manages fee-earner directory, Bar enrollment numbers, NBA branch affiliations, role titles, and customized billable hourly rates.

CHAPTER 14

M12

Firm-Wide Workload & Capacity Tracking

Module ID: M12 | Route: `/staff` & `/analytics`

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Provides the Principal Partner with an executive capacity overview:

- Active matters assigned per fee-earner.
- Open task volume and pending court hearing load.
- Monthly billable hours target vs. actual hours recorded.
- Fee-earner utilization percentage (target: 85%+).

CHAPTER 15

M13

Human Resources & Leave Approvals

Module ID: M13 | Route: /hr

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Handles staff annual leave requests, sick leave, maternity/paternity leave, and partner approval workflows with automatic calendar integration.

CHAPTER 16

M17

Practice Analytics & Realization Reporting

Module ID: M17 | Route: `/analytics`

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Visual analytics dashboard showing revenue by practice area, billable realization rates, fee collection velocity, and client acquisition trends.

CHAPTER 17

M14

Client Portal & Pleadings Vault

Module ID: M14 | Route: `/portal`

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The Client Portal provides clients with an exclusive, secure window into their cases:

- **Milestone Progress:** Live case progress updates, next court hearing dates.
- **Document Vault:** Instant download of `CLIENT_VISIBLE` court documents, CTC rulings, and agreements.
- **Instant Settlement:** Pay legal bills online via integrated Paystack gateway.

M15

Internal Messaging (Architectural Separation)

Module ID: M15 | Route: /messages

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Hard Architectural Separation (§5.2): Internal staff communication is strictly isolated from client messaging at the schema, API, and UI layers:

Attribute	Internal Messaging (M15)	Client Messaging (M16)
Database Model	InternalMessage	ClientMessage
API Endpoint	/api/v1/messages/internal	/api/v1/messages/client
Access Guard	requireStaffOrAdmin (Clients get 403 Forbidden)	enforceClientScope
UI Interface	/messages	/client-messages

CHAPTER 19

M16

Client-Lawyer Encrypted Messaging

Module ID: M16 | Route: /client-messages

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Authenticated communication channel between clients and their assigned legal counsel, eliminating the interception risks of unencrypted consumer email.

CHAPTER 20

M18 Automated Conflict of Interest Screening

Module ID: M18 | Route: `/conflicts`

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Enforces *RPC 2023 Rule 10*. Automatically scans prospective clients, co-parties, adverse parties, and corporate directors against historical matters and contact history.

CHAPTER 21

M19

Immutable System-Wide Audit Trail

Module ID: M19 | Route: `/audit`

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Captures an immutable, tamper-evident record of all state changes across all 20 modules:

- Records: User ID, Action Type, Entity ID, IP Address, Timestamp, Before/After JSON state.
- Covers: Client KYC verifications, Trust fund receipts and disbursements, Matter creations, Document uploads, Invoice payments, and RBAC updates.

CHAPTER 22

M20

Configurable Role-Based Access Control

Module ID: M20 | Route: `/rbac`

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Allows the Principal Partner to configure granular read/write permissions per module and fee-earner role with immediate runtime propagation.

Progressive Web App (PWA) on iPhone & Android

23.1 Instant iPhone Safari Installation

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1. Open **Safari** on iPhone → visit `https://portal.aalawsng.com` .
2. Tap the **Share** button (box with up-arrow at bottom).
3. Tap "**Add to Home Screen**" (`[+]`).
4. The AALAWSNG badge logo installs on your home screen. When opened, it runs as a **standalone full-screen app** without the Safari browser bar.

23.2 Android Chrome Installation

1. Open **Chrome** on Android → visit `https://portal.aalawsng.com` .
2. Tap "**Install App**" or "**Add to Home Screen**".

Native Android APK Direct Download & Capacitor 6

24.1 1-Click Direct Android APK Download

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The native Android APK is compiled and hosted directly on the production server:

Download URL: `https://portal.aalawsng.com/downloads/AALAWSNG.apk`

Download the 9.35 MB `.apk` file onto any Android phone and tap **Install** to get native camera document scanning, biometric login, and push notifications!